

TOUCHSCREEN

The New Language in Mobile Technology

It may appear a simple task to buy a touchscreen mobile phone. But with so many features, styles and brands available in the market, you need to know the technology well before you purchase one. Read on to learn more about touchscreen phones that may add a 'WOW' to your style and enhance your user experience

■ SHWETA DHADIWAL

The mobile handset market has become one of the most competitive markets in the country. To sell every new feature introduced in handsets, there is a tough competition among vendors, who often do not hesitate to lower prices. Under these circumstances, a manufacturer has no choice but to offer stylish and quality designs, in order to have an edge over his competitors.

Presently, touchscreen phones are a rage among people because of their smart concept, style, mass appeal, and functional benefits. "The popularity of touchscreen is based on its ability to interact with the user directly through screen, rather than indirectly through a mouse or touch pad," says Anil Arora, business group marketing head-mobile communications, LG Electronics India Ltd.

Moreover, touchscreen phones are more convenient to use. "Some of their unique features, such as excellent user interface, multi-touch and gesture recognition, are enjoyed by majority of the users," says Arora, further enunciating the

competence of touchscreen phones.

The touch technology

There are a number of technologies behind touchscreens but most popular for cellphones, personal digital assistants (PDAs) or mobile Internet devices are resistive and capacitive touch technologies. These have been cate-

gorised on the basis of the touch sensing methods they use. Along with touchscreens, touch flow software is also needed to make them work and interact with users.

The resistive-touch technology is water and dust resistant but get easily scratched. It can detect a touch by any kind of object like a finger or a stylus.

But, unfortunately, it can only detect single touch. "Most of the touchscreen phones in India are based on the resistive-touch technology," explains Anil Kaushik, executive vice president, Fly mobile. It is the least expensive touchscreen technology available in the market. Whenever you read or hear about 4-wire or 5-wire, you must know that it is related to the resistive-touchscreen technology.

Capacitive touchscreen became popular with the launch of Apple's iPhone. Some of the reasons for its popularity are its scratch resistance feature and the capability of detecting multiple touches. But, it can be activated only with an object that constantly emits electric flow—like human fingers. Capacitive touchscreen phones are also more



LG Cookie KP500 touch phone